ElitePublishing

BY ELITE PUBLISHING AGENCY

FICTION NICHE RESEARCH · BOOK DIRECTION

Three directions for your first fiction series

A romantasy-led study of reader demand, competition and comparable books, with a ready-to-write concept for each niche, built for the Premium novella format and planned as a series from day one.

01 Monster Romance

02 Cozy Romantasy

03 Paranormal Cozy Mystery

Prepared for
Mijke

Market
Amazon Kindle · KU

Date
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SUMMARY

Your brief and our recommendation

You asked for a fiction book that is close to the romantasy you love, that can grow into a series, and that fits the Premium package (a manuscript of up to 15,000 words, written and formatted for Kindle).

OUR TOP PICK

Monster Romance: The Orc King's Bargain

This is the romantasy-adjacent niche where a 15,000-word novella is a normal format and not a compromise. Readers binge it on Kindle Unlimited, and every book can introduce a new couple in the same world, which keeps the series easy to grow.

The three directions side by side

	01 · Monster Romance	02 · Cozy Romantasy	03 · Paranormal Cozy Mystery
Closeness to romantasy	●●●●○	●●●●●	●●○○○
Novella format accepted	●●●●●	●●●○○	●●●●○
Reader demand	High, strong on KU & BookTok	High and growing fast	High, stable evergreen
Competition	Medium, mostly indie	Medium, rising	High, needs a clear hook
Series potential	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●●●
Heat level	Medium–high (adjustable)	Low–medium	Clean
Our ranking	**1st** BEST FIT	**2nd**, the cosiest option	**3rd**, the long-series play

Why we steered away from mainstream romantasy

Epic romantasy (fae courts, dragon riders) sells the most, but it is also the most crowded. Big publishers lead it, and readers expect novels of 90,000 words or more, so a novella placed there is judged against those books. In the three sub-niches above, short reads are an established, loved format. A well-crafted 15,000-word book can compete there on equal terms, and the series can be published faster.

> **How we picked them:** close to romantasy, indie authors among the bestsellers, novellas accepted, strong Kindle Unlimited readership and readers who follow series.

THE MARKET IN 2026

Fantasy and romance lead Kindle fiction

These figures are industry estimates from third-party market reports, not official Amazon numbers. They show where reader money is going and why a precise niche matters.

≈ 4 : 1

Fantasy outsells science fiction on Kindle

Romantasy and LitRPG drive the gap, and fantasy recorded its strongest average sales rank to date.

K-lytics, Summer 2026 report (via Author Media)

$66.9M

Kindle Unlimited fund, May 2026

This was an all-time record. KU pays authors for every page read, so binge-friendly series benefit most.

KDP Select Global Fund (via Author Media)

+24%

Romance unit growth in the US

51 million romance books were sold in a year, and romantasy was among the fastest-growing segments.

Circana BookScan (via PublishDrive)

+18%

More competing fantasy titles in one year

Demand is strong but supply is rising too, which is why we target sub-niches and avoid the broad category.

K-lytics, Summer 2026 report (via Author Media)

What this means for your book

- **The demand is real and it sits next to romantasy.** Cozy fantasy is described as one of the hottest niches of 2026, and monster romance has moved from indie corners into the mainstream.
- **Kindle Unlimited rewards series.** Readers who finish Book 1 move straight on to Book 2, so later books earn more as the series grows. Single standalone books rarely build momentum.
- **Novellas give you speed.** Shorter books let a series reach three instalments sooner. A visible series page on Amazon is one of the strongest signals for new readers.
- **The niche has to be specific.** With competition rising, books win by matching an exact reader craving (a trope, a creature, a setting), not by being broadly "fantasy".

Reading Amazon rankings

Every Kindle book has a Best Sellers Rank (BSR). Independent estimates for the US Kindle store suggest roughly 1,000 sales a day at #100, about 13 a day at #10,000 and about 1 a day at #100,000. Holding a rank under 30,000 in a sub-niche is a solid result for a new author. Ranks move daily, and these conversions are estimates with a margin of error.

Source: Automateed BSR calculator, calibrated July 2026.

DIRECTION 01 BEST FIT

Monster Romance

Fantasy romance where the love interest is a non-human "monster" (orcs, demons, gargoyles, aliens). The tone is romantic and swoony, with a guaranteed happy ending.

WHY IT WORKS

- It is one of romance's breakout trends. It moved from self-published corners into the mainstream, and BookTok and Kindle Unlimited keep it going.
- It has dedicated reader events, such as the Monster Romance "Stuff Your Kindle" day on 31 October 2026.
- Indie authors lead it, so there is room for new names.
- Novellas of 15,000–40,000 words are standard, so your book will meet reader expectations.

TARGET READER

Women aged 25–45 who read romantasy, are heavy KU users and binge several books a week. They look for tropes like *arranged marriage*, *he falls first* and *grumpy/sunshine*.

COMPARABLE BOOKS & POSITIONING

Book / series	What it teaches us
Ice Planet Barbarians Ruby Dixon	This is the series that took the niche mainstream. Each book follows a new couple in one shared world.
Duskwalker Brides Opal Reyne	A "brides" series title signals the trope instantly. The covers lean dark and romantic.

WATCH-OUTS

The heat level must be decided early and kept the same across the series. Covers in this niche are illustrated, not photographic, which suits a pen name.

SERIES · THORNWOOD BRIDES

Book 1: The Orc King's Bargain

To save her village she agreed to marry a monster. Nobody warned her he would be the gentlest thing in the Thornwood.

BOOK 1 IN BRIEF

Elara, a royal mapmaker, is sent to marry Varr, king of the Thornwood orcs, to seal a fragile peace. She expects a beast. Instead she finds a ruler who keeps a library, who asks before he touches her and whose attention unravels her. When someone from her own court sabotages the treaty, Elara must choose between the crown that sold her and the king who chose her.

SERIES PLAN

1. **The Orc King's Bargain**: Elara & Varr
2. **The Minotaur's Forge**: a runaway healer & the blacksmith
3. **The Gargoyle's Vow**: a cursed bookbinder & her stone guardian

BOOK SPECS

Length	**15,000 words (novella)**
POV	**Dual, first person**
Heat	**Medium–high (your call)**
Ending	**HEA, standalone couple**
Tropes	**Arranged marriage, he falls first**
Launch price	**$2.99 + Kindle Unlimited**
Keywords	**orc romance, monster romance novella**

DIRECTION 02

Cozy Romantasy

Romantic fantasy with a warm, low-stakes heart: magical shops, small villages, found family and a love story at the centre. It is the "comfort read" side of romantasy.

WHY IT WORKS

- Market analysts named cozy fantasy one of the hottest niches of 2026. It is still described as an emerging niche with demand that is not yet fully met.
- It has its own Amazon bestseller category and its own reader promotions, such as the October 2026 cozy fantasy & romantasy events.
- Book 1 of indie series (often 4–13 books long) appear in the category charts.

TARGET READER

Romantasy readers aged 25–55 who want comfort over carnage. They respond to cottagecore aesthetics, tea shops, bookshops and gentle magic.

COMPARABLE BOOKS & POSITIONING

Book / series	What it teaches us
Legends & Lattes Travis Baldree	It proved the "cozy" demand: a shop, a found family and low stakes.
The Very Secret Society of Irregular Witches Sangu Mandanna	It reached the top of the Cozy Fantasy charts. Witches, warmth and romance are the winning mix.
Magical Midlife Madness K.F. Breene	It shows how far a cozy-magic indie series can run, at 13+ books.

WATCH-OUTS

At 15,000 words we position it clearly as a *cozy novella*, so readers expect a short, comforting read. The niche is attracting new releases quickly, so timing helps.

SERIES · WILLOWMERE TALES

Book 1: Tea & Thorns at the Moonlit Apothecary

A runaway witch, a suspicious fae knight, and a little tea shop at the edge of the enchanted wood.

BOOK 1 IN BRIEF

Wren has left her coven and only wants a quiet life brewing teas in the village of Willowmere. Ash, the brooding fae warden of the woods, is convinced she is trouble. When the village's midwinter lantern festival is threatened by a fading enchantment, the witch and the warden have to work together. Neither of them planned on falling for the other.

SERIES PLAN

1. **Tea & Thorns**: Wren & Ash
2. **Bread & Embers**: the baker & the retired dragon
3. **Ink & Starlight**: the bookseller & the ghost librarian

BOOK SPECS

Length	**15,000 words (cozy novella)**
POV	**Dual, third person**
Heat	**Low–medium**
Ending	**HEA, standalone couple**
Tropes	**Grumpy/sunshine, found family**
Launch price	**$2.99 + Kindle Unlimited**
Keywords	**cozy fantasy romance, cozy witch novella**

DIRECTION 03

Paranormal Cozy Mystery

A light, clean mystery with witches, ghosts or a talking familiar, plus a slow-burn romance running across the series. It is the most "bingeable" series format in Kindle Unlimited.

WHY IT WORKS

- It is an evergreen niche with very loyal readers who follow a series for 10 books or more.
- The Kindle Unlimited category is full of long series and box sets, which shows that readers move from one book to the next.
- Novellas of 15,000–40,000 words are common and accepted.

TARGET READER

Women aged 35–65 who are avid KU readers. They prefer clean content and love quirky towns, pets with personality and puzzles they can solve along with the heroine.

COMPARABLE BOOKS & POSITIONING

Book / series	What it teaches us
Witches' Brew Morgana Best	Puns in the titles and a strong series branding.
Witches of Holiday Hills Carolyn Ridder Aspenson	A small-town setting, with box sets used to boost read-through.

WATCH-OUTS

This is the most crowded of the three (more than 10,000 Kindle results). It needs a distinctive hook, which is why we use a Dutch setting that is rare in the genre. It is also the furthest from romantasy.

SERIES · HEX & TULIPS MYSTERIES

Book 1: Tulips, Toil & Trouble

A canal-side flower shop, a sarcastic black cat and a murder in the tulip market.

BOOK 1 IN BRIEF

Fenna inherits her grandmother's flower shop in Amsterdam. With it come a talking cat familiar and the news that she is a witch. When a rival florist is found dead at the tulip market and Fenna becomes the prime suspect, she has to clear her name with help from Oma's ghost, while a far-too-handsome police inspector keeps getting in the way.

SERIES PLAN

1. **Tulips, Toil & Trouble**: the tulip market murder
2. **A Hex on the Herengracht**: death on a canal cruise
3. **Bike, Broom & Bones**: a cold case at the windmill

BOOK SPECS

Length	**15,000 words (novella)**
POV	**First person, Fenna**
Heat	**Clean, slow-burn romance**
Ending	**Case solved, series arc open**
Hooks	**Witch, cat familiar, Dutch setting**
Launch price	**$2.99 + Kindle Unlimited**
Keywords	**paranormal cozy mystery, witch mystery**

RECOMMENDATION

Where we would start

Our recommendation is **Direction 01: Monster Romance, *The Orc King's Bargain***. It keeps the romantasy feeling you enjoy, the novella length is exactly what its readers expect, and the "new couple in the same world" structure makes Books 2 and 3 straightforward. If you would prefer a softer, lower-heat book, **Direction 02: Cozy Romantasy** is an excellent alternative.

> All three concepts are starting points. You can change the names, the setting or the heat level, or combine elements from different directions. We will refine everything with you in the outline stage.

Your Premium package

Up to 15,000 words
The complete novella manuscript.

Outline first
A chapter-by-chapter outline for your approval, with notes for Books 2–3.

Written & formatted
The manuscript written and formatted, ready for Kindle.

21-day delivery
From your approval of the direction.

5 revisions
So the book feels exactly like yours.

US$1,250
One package, with no extra cost for the format.

How we move forward

1 Choose
Pick your direction, or tell us what to mix.

2 Order
We send the Premium package offer.

3 Outline
You approve the plot, characters and series notes.

4 Write
We draft, edit and revise with your feedback.

5 Deliver
You receive the formatted manuscript, ready for KDP.

Sources

- Author Media: "Cozy Fantasy and LitRPG Surge as Hottest Niches in 2026" (K-lytics Summer 2026 data)
- Author Media: "Kindle Unlimited Pays Indie Authors Record-Breaking Royalties"
- K-lytics: Fantasy Romance / Romantasy market report, April 2026
- PublishDrive: "The Rise of Romantasy" (Circana BookScan data)
- Accio: "Top Selling KDP Books, 2026 Guide"
- Bookzee: "Why Romantasy and Cozy Fantasy are Trending in 2026"
- Blue Rose One: "Monster Romance Novels (2026)"
- Bestie and the Bookish: "2026 Stuff Your Kindle Events"
- Automateed: Amazon BSR sales calculator (July 2026)
- Amazon.com: Cozy Fantasy and Paranormal Cozy Mystery category listings

Market figures are third-party estimates and are given for guidance only. Niche research gives a better-informed starting point but cannot guarantee sales. Book and series titles mentioned as comparables belong to their respective authors and publishers.